

Tom Perel

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EDUCATION

Northwood High School

Irvine, CA

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, AP Computer Science A, AP Statistics Aug. 2021 – June 2025

Irvine Valley College

Irvine, CA

Computer Science

Expected graduation 2029

- Tutor at the Natural Science Center for CS36 (C), CS37 (C++), and CS10 (Python)
- Technical Officer of the IVC Artificial Intelligence Club
- Member of the IVC Honors Program
- Participant in the RAMP research program
 - * Partnered with another honors student to work on research into NLP Personalization using RAG
 - * Research presented at the HTCC conference (UC Riverside)
- Member of the IVC Computer Science club
 - * Ran a hands-on Git workshop for the club

EXPERIENCE

Section Leader (Python Instructor)

April 2026 – Present

Stanford University

- Selected out of 2000+ applicants to teach CS 106A through Code in Place.
- Acting Python Instructor for a cohort of 10+ students, leading weekly live coding sessions and code reviews.

AI Research Intern

June 2025 – Present

Turing

- Working with AI agents to optimize LLM training data and reasoning traces for advanced college coursework through research for high-profile clients such as OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic.

Website Development Team Lead

Sep. 2025 – Present

HackCC

- Assembled and leading team of 6 community college students on the development of the HackCC main site, used by 500+ prospective applicants of the HackCC hackathon.
- Created documentation for new onboards about setting up the environment using VirtualBox & Ubuntu. Documentation covers Docker setup, VSCode Setup, Connection to Git, Potential troubleshooting, and helpful resources.

PROJECTS

Evaluating Adversarial Vulnerabilities in Modern Large Language Models | *Pandas, Matplotlib, LaTeX*

- Won "Outstanding Oral Presentation" out of 160 participants for solo research on 'Evaluating Adversarial Vulnerabilities in Modern Large Language Models' at the IVC/Saddleback Research Symposium
- Wrote and published a cited research paper on arXiv
 - * Cleaned and calculated statistics using Pandas

SideQuest | *SQLAlchemy, Node.js, FastAPI*

- Developed a multimodal AI pipeline utilizing Gemini Vision to automate real-time photo verification.
- Led a 3-person squad to win 1st place Overall & the Community Track out of 80+ participants at LaserHacks 2026.

Portrait | *React, FastAPI, SQLite, Canvas LMS API, Langchain*

- Awarded 1st place for the AI Track at UCI HackTheCoast 2026, competing against 60+ participants
- Engineered a full-stack RAG pipeline using FastAPI and LangChain to index Canvas LMS data and PDF syllabi, providing Gemini-powered task prioritization and context-aware chatbot.

CERTIFICATIONS

Freecodecamp: Responsive Web Design, Scientific Computing with Python

CyberForward Academy: Became "Foundation Certified" from Coastline ROP following a semester-long class on AI & Cybersecurity